

We Knew It All Along!

This is downright funny. *The Wall Street Journal* carried an article about how record labels are now admitting that file sharing is indeed a way to market to music fans! It's laughable, but, well, it's a small step forward.



Lots Of Old-Timers Out There

One in three Americans write down computer passwords, a new study shows. "This is a lot like mom and dad buying a great new security system for the house and junior leaving the combination under the doormat," says an analyst about the new finding...



Escape

"DUMBER THAN HIGH-SCHOOLERS"

Smarts Tags For Bloggers?

Look at these two sentences, which mean pretty much the same thing: (1) Democracy has proven itself as a better governmental proposition time and again. Consider, for example, the fall of the former USSR. (2) democracy is good you see its always good. the USSR was communist and they failed.

Notice the difference? Some bloggers write as in (1), and some prefer the new-age (2). OK, the second one is an extreme example, and most bloggers fall somewhere in between. Anyway, someone over at scienceblogs.com got the communistic gem of an idea of testing whether the average blogger really does write well, the idea being that those who write regularly for fun *should* be able to churn out better prose. The recent Blogger

SAT Challenge invited bloggers and blog readers from around the world to test their skill at writing SAT-style essays.

So what were the results? You'd be surprised. Scienceblogs.com came up with "Bloggers Dumber Than High-School Kids." OK, there's all the messy details about test conditions, statistical relevance and all, but that was the conclusion.

A bloke called Dave Munger then disputed that finding, and thought up a new comparison—between bloggers and non-bloggers. Oh, the variety of serious graphs and calculations on his page—to prove that bloggers are a smarter bunch! And then lots of people went ahead and dug the page.

We gather that people seem to be getting more

sensitive to the fact that some blogs are crap and some are enlightening; that some bloggers are ramblers and some can be philosophers and friends.

But then comes an interesting, un-democratic thought. In the spirit of the aforementioned exercise, how about making it mandatory for bloggers to have a photo ID on their blogs? This could display such details such as IQ, age, sexual preference, and so forth, so we can filter out the bleats of:

1. Imbeciles (IQ below 80)
2. Women (for MCPs)
3. Kids (in case their age isn't apparent)
4. Fuddy-duddies (dated views)

And on the list can go. Heck, who needs a Semantic Web when we can have a Smarts Web that works this way?

Whatever Happened To...

Broadband Over Power Lines

As long ago as the year 2000 (well, long in tech terms, anyway), there came the idea that one should be able to access the Internet using cabling that's already there in their homes—power cables. Thus, Broadband over Power Lines (BPL) was born. The idea was (and still is) brilliant, especially when you look at the promise—just plug your broadband modem into a power connection, and be treated to 200 Mbps of glorious bandwidth. It uses already existing power infrastructure, so there's virtually no installation cost—perfect for rural areas.

Then came the opponents. Apparently, BPL interferes with about a billion other services around it—broadcast and HAM radio, aircraft frequencies, and generally any electrical signal unfortunate enough to be in the vicinity. You wouldn't want to bring an aircraft down every time you blogged, would you? And so, the BPL companies went home, tail between their legs.

As of August 2005, though, BPL Global Ltd. has started providing broadband to its customers, after convincing the US Federal Communications Commission (FCC) that if done right, BPL doesn't interfere with any radio frequency, so the world's already frightened air passengers can breathe a sigh of relief.

Win! My Desktop

Last month's winner is Arkopal Bhattacharya
Congratulations!

Here's how he made his Mac-crazy desktop:

1. FinderBar 1.3 for a MAC OSX style taskbar.
2. RAM and CPU meter widget for DesktopX
3. ClockX for the apple clock
4. ObjectDock for a MAC style dock bar
5. Wallpaper from macdesktops.com

Participate in this contest and win next month

XML

by Mitch Amiano, Conrad D'Cruz, Kay Ethier & Michael D. Thomas
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Send your Desktop with a description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject "My Desktop", and tell us your postal address, too.